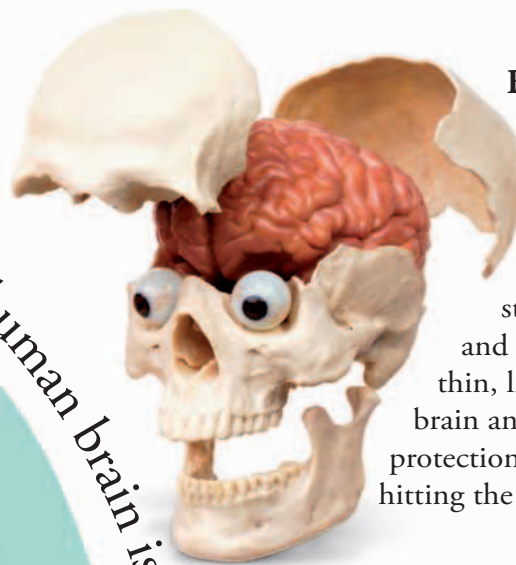




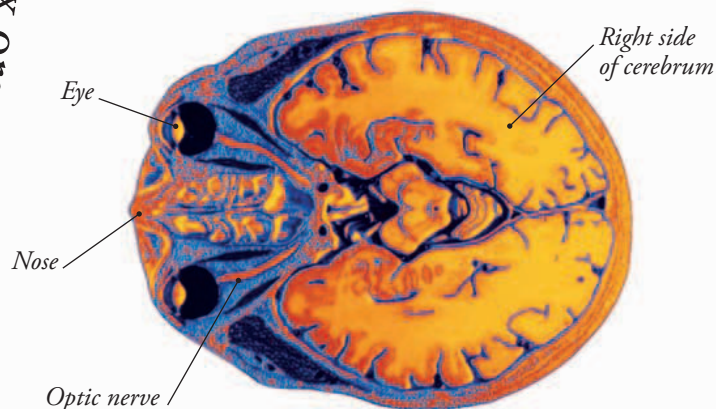
BRAIN PROTECTION

Your soft, delicate brain is protected from knocks and blows by the bones of the skull. These lock together to form a hard, strong case that supports and encloses your brain. A thin, liquid cushion between the brain and the bone provides extra protection to stop the brain from hitting the skull after a sudden jolt.



SEEING THE BRAIN

This image shows a “slice” through the head of a healthy person. It was produced using an MRI scanner. Scanning methods such as MRI are normally used to look for signs of damage or disease. Revealed in the MRI scan here are the left and right sides of the cerebrum, seen from above. You can also see the eyes and the optic nerves leading to the brain.



BLOOD SUPPLY

Brain cells need constant supplies of glucose (fuel) and oxygen to give them enough energy to work properly. These essentials are delivered by the many blood vessels (arteries in red, veins in blue) that supply the head. In fact, one-fifth of the body's entire quota of blood goes to the brain. If the blood supply is interrupted, the brain will die or be severely damaged within minutes.



The grooves in the brain are called sulci and the bulges are called gyri.

The human brain is the most complex organ in the entire living world.

The cerebellum is situated at the base of the brain, behind the brain stem.

The brain stem controls functions you don't have to think about, such as breathing and digestion.

The spinal cord relays signals between the brain and every part of the body.

